

United States History and Geography — Student Form

United States History and Geography · Tennessee Academic Standards 2027-28 · Form FORM-A

classroom-formative · pre-field-test. Item parameters are estimates and have not met a student; this form is not a calibrated instrument.

1. What did the Reconstruction Finance Corporation (RFC) do under Hoover?

- A.** Raised tariffs to the highest levels in U.S. history, worsening the global Depression
- B.** Loaned government money to banks, railroads, and large businesses to prevent failures
- C.** Businesses cut wages and jobs anyway to survive; voluntary measures had no enforcement
- D.** WWI veterans demanding early bonus payment; Hoover ordered military to disperse them

2. What was the Bonus Army and how did Hoover respond?

- A.** Businesses cut wages and jobs anyway to survive; voluntary measures had no enforcement
- B.** Raised tariffs to the highest levels in U.S. history, worsening the global Depression
- C.** WWI veterans demanding early bonus payment; Hoover ordered military to disperse them
- D.** Loaned government money to banks, railroads, and large businesses to prevent failures

3. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows a TVA dam completed during the New Deal era. (Photograph, c. 1936. Public Domain.) How did New Deal programs like the TVA, shown in this photograph, represent a change in the role of the federal government?

- A.** The government reduced its involvement in the economy and allowed private industry to manage recovery
- B.** The federal government's role remained unchanged from the policies of the 1920s
- C.** The TVA was a private utility corporation that operated without any federal funding or oversight
- D.** The federal government took direct responsibility for economic development and public welfare

4. Why did critics of the New Deal charge that FDR's programs represented socialism?

- A.** Because the New Deal greatly expanded federal regulation of the economy and created public employment and Social Security
- B.** Because FDR eliminated private property rights by redistributing land from wealthy Americans to the poor
- C.** Because New Deal programs abolished all private and religious charities in favor of state services
- D.** Because FDR called for nationalizing all major American industries and placing them under government ownership

5. Design a "New Deal Report Card" that grades THREE specific programs on two criteria: (1) effectiveness in addressing the immediate crisis, and (2) long-term impact on American government and society. For each program, assign a letter grade (A-F) for each criterion and justify your grading with specific historical evidence.

6. DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION Directions: Analyze the three primary sources below. Then respond to the prompt using evidence from ALL THREE documents and your own historical knowledge. --- DOCUMENT A National Industrial Recovery Act, Section 1 (Declaration of Policy), June 16, 1933 (National Archives, public domain): "A national emergency productive of widespread unemployment and disorganization of industry, which burdens interstate and foreign commerce...is hereby declared to exist. It is hereby declared to be the policy of Congress to remove obstructions to the free flow of interstate and foreign commerce which tend to diminish the amount thereof; and to provide for the general welfare by promoting the organization of industry for the purpose of cooperative action among trade groups..." --- DOCUMENT B National Labor Relations Act (Wagner Act), Section 1 (Findings and Policy), July 5, 1935 (National Archives, public domain): "The inequality of bargaining power between employees who do not possess full freedom of association or actual liberty of contract, and employers who are organized in the corporate or other forms of ownership association substantially burdens and affects the flow of commerce...It is hereby declared to be the policy of the United States to eliminate the causes of certain substantial obstructions to the free flow of commerce...by protecting the exercise by workers of full freedom of association, self-organization, and designation of representatives of their own choosing." --- DOCUMENT C FDR, Message to Congress on Tax Revision, June 19, 1935 (FDR Presidential Library, public domain): "Our revenue laws have operated in many ways to the unfair advantage of the few, and they have done little to prevent an unjust concentration of wealth and economic power...The very wealthy may be able to hire the ablest tax lawyers so that the letter of the tax law is followed but not the spirit...Inherited economic power is as inconsistent with the ideals of this generation as inherited political power was inconsistent with the ideals of the generation which established our Government." --- PROMPT: Using all three documents and your knowledge of the New Deal (1933–1938), construct an argument that answers: How did the New Deal evolve from the First New Deal (1933–1934) to the Second New Deal (1935–1938), and what does this evolution reveal about FDR's response to political pressure from critics on both the left and right? In your response, you MUST: 1. Analyze each document using the HIPP framework — at least ONE HIPP element per document. 2. Place each document within the First or Second New Deal phase and explain what governing philosophy it reflects. 3. Construct a central argument using all three documents AND at least two outside historical facts explaining how the shift from Document A to Documents B and C reflects a meaningful philosophical and political evolution in the New Deal. 4. Evaluate: Was the Second New Deal a genuine ideological shift toward redistribution and worker empowerment, or primarily a political strategy to neutralize critics like Huey Long and the Supreme Court?

7. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows American soldiers during the Korean War, c. 1950. U.S. forces were deployed to South Korea as part of a United Nations coalition after North Korean forces invaded South Korea in June 1950. (U.S. Army photograph, c. 1950. Public Domain.) The deployment of American troops shown in this photograph was part of the U.S. strategy of what?

- A. Imperialism
- B. Containment
- C. Détente
- D. Isolationism

8. Marshall's speech announced what became known as which initiative?

- A. The Berlin Airlift to the blockaded city
- B. The Eisenhower Doctrine for the Middle East
- C. The Marshall Plan for European recovery
- D. The North Atlantic Treaty Organization

9. Read the excerpt below. "The Grand Alliance between the United States, Great Britain, and the Soviet Union rests upon one thing only — our common enemy. When Hitler is defeated, I wonder what will hold us together." — Diplomat George Kennan, Private Memo, 1944 Which of the following best describes the fragility of the World War II Allied alliance referenced in this excerpt?

- A. Personal conflicts between Roosevelt, Churchill, and Stalin made sustained military cooperation nearly impossible.
- B. The creation of the United Nations divided the Allies into competing blocs before the war even ended.
- C. The three Allies had agreed to share all military technology, creating economic competition that strained relations.
- D. The Alliance was held together only by a common enemy, masking ideological differences that surfaced once Germany was defeated

10. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows a U.S. Air Force C-54 Skymaster cargo plane flying low over a crowd of German civilians as it approaches Tempelhof Airport in Berlin during the summer of 1948. (Photograph, 1948. U.S. Air Force.) How did the Berlin Airlift shown in this photograph reflect the U.S. policy of containment during the early Cold War?

- A. The U.S. showed resolve against Soviet expansion without direct force
- B. The U.S. used military force to drive Soviet troops out of the eastern sector of Berlin
- C. The U.S. negotiated a peace treaty that divided Germany into permanent zones
- D. The U.S. imposed economic sanctions that forced the Soviet Union to end communism

11. Compare the Marshall Plan (1948) with modern American foreign aid programs. What principles from the Marshall Plan's success could be applied to current challenges? What limitations would such an approach face today?

12. DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION: The Origins of the Cold War Directions: Read the following three primary source excerpts and then respond to the prompt below. In your response, analyze each document using the HIPP framework (Historical context, Intended audience, Purpose, Point of view) and construct an evidence-based argument. --- DOCUMENT A: George Kennan, "The Long Telegram," February 22, 1946 — declassified U.S. State Department cable, available through the National Archives: "We have here a political force committed fanatically to the belief that with US there can be no permanent *modus vivendi*, that it is desirable and necessary that the internal harmony of our society be disrupted, our traditional way of life be destroyed, the international authority of our state be broken, if Soviet power is to be secured." DOCUMENT B: Winston Churchill, "The Sinews of Peace" (Iron Curtain Speech), Westminster College, Fulton, Missouri, March 5, 1946 — public address, transcript available through Westminster College archives: "From Stettin in the Baltic to Trieste in the Adriatic, an iron curtain has descended across the Continent. Behind that line lie all the capitals of the ancient states of Central and Eastern Europe... all are subject in one form or another, not only to Soviet influence but to a very high and in many cases increasing measure of control from Moscow." DOCUMENT C: Harry S. Truman, Address to Congress (Truman Doctrine), March 12, 1947 — U.S. government document, National Archives: "At the present moment in world history nearly every nation must choose between alternative ways of life. The choice is too often not a free one. One way of life is based upon the will of the majority... The second way of life is based upon the will of a minority forcibly imposed upon the majority." --- Using all three documents and your knowledge of Cold War origins (US.59–US.60), construct an argument that evaluates the relative roles of ideology and geopolitical strategy in causing the Cold War. Apply HIPP analysis to at least two of the three documents and use outside historical knowledge to support your argument. Your response should address: (1) what each document reveals about U.S./Western perceptions of the Soviet threat; (2) whether the Cold War was primarily an ideological conflict or a geopolitical competition for power; and (3) whether alternative outcomes were possible given the structural conditions of 1945–1947.

13. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows the massive excavation of the Culebra Cut during construction of the Panama Canal, c. 1910. Workers and heavy equipment can be seen carving through the mountainous terrain of the Panamanian isthmus. (Photograph, c. 1910. Public Domain.) Which president was MOST responsible for initiating the construction project shown in this photograph?

- A. William McKinley
- B. Theodore Roosevelt
- C. William Howard Taft
- D. Woodrow Wilson

14. Use the political cartoon to answer the question. The 1898 cartoon shows Uncle Sam seated at a restaurant table, looking at a menu containing 'Cuba Steak,' 'Porto Rico Pig,' 'Philippine Floating Islands,' and 'Sandwich Islands (Hawaii).' President McKinley stands as the waiter. The cartoon comments on American territorial expansion after the Spanish-American War. In this cartoon, what does Uncle Sam being seated at the restaurant menu most directly represent?

- A.** The United States refusing to accept any new territorial responsibilities after defeating Spain
- B.** American diplomats negotiating new trade agreements with independent Caribbean republics
- C.** The United States choosing which territories to acquire after defeating Spain
- D.** President McKinley choosing between military options for fighting the Spanish-American War

15. Read the excerpt below. "I took the Canal Zone and let Congress debate, and while the debate goes on, the canal does also." — President Theodore Roosevelt, Lecture at University of California, 1911 Which of the following best describes the controversy surrounding Roosevelt's acquisition of the Panama Canal Zone?

- A.** Roosevelt used U.S. taxpayer money to pay other nations to build the canal without congressional authorization.
- B.** Panama declared independence from Spain with U.S. support specifically to gain the economic benefits of the canal.
- C.** Roosevelt seized the Canal Zone from France, which had originally agreed to sell it to the United States but then backed out.
- D.** The U.S. backed Panama's revolution against Colombia to obtain the canal rights

16. Read the excerpt below. "The construction of the canal required the labor of tens of thousands of workers — Jamaicans, Barbadians, Spanish workers — in brutal tropical conditions. Yellow fever and malaria killed thousands before Dr. Gorgas brought the diseases under control." — David McCullough, *The Path Between the Seas*, 1977 Which of the following best describes a major challenge that had to be overcome to complete the Panama Canal?

- A.** Tropical disease, especially yellow fever and malaria, killed thousands of workers until a mosquito-control campaign cut the death rate
- B.** The lack of adequate explosives technology meant engineers had to rely entirely on hand-dug excavations.
- C.** The engineers had to redirect four major rivers that flooded the construction site annually.
- D.** The project faced a severe labor shortage because American workers refused to work in tropical conditions.

17. Analyze how American imperialism in the late 1800s reflected BOTH idealistic and self-interested motivations. Use evidence from at least THREE specific events or policies (e.g., Spanish-American War, annexation of Hawaii, Open Door Policy, Panama Canal, Philippine-American War). Then evaluate whether imperialism ultimately strengthened or weakened American democratic ideals.

18. Document-Based Question: The Spanish-American War and the Question of Empire, 1898 Directions: Read the three documents below. Then write a well-organized essay that constructs an argument addressing the following question: Did the Spanish-American War represent a turning point in American foreign policy, or was it the inevitable product of forces already at work in American society and politics? Your essay must: — Apply SOAPS analysis (Speaker, Occasion, Audience, Purpose, Significance) to at least two of the three documents — Use evidence from all three documents — Incorporate outside knowledge of the period — Construct a clear, defensible argument --- DOCUMENT 1 President William McKinley, War Message to Congress, April 11, 1898 — Bryan, William Jennings, ed., *Republic or Empire* (1899), public domain, public domain: "The present condition of affairs in Cuba is a constant menace to our peace and entails upon this Government an enormous expense. With such a conflict waged for years in an island so near our border and with which our people have such trade and business relations; when the lives and liberty of our citizens are in constant danger and their property destroyed and themselves ruined; where our trading vessels are liable to seizure and are seized at our very door by warships of a foreign nation — the expedient of enforcing American interests will justify forceful intervention." --- DOCUMENT 2 Teller Amendment, April 20, 1898, Bryan, William Jennings, ed., *Republic or Empire* (1899), public domain — public domain: "Resolved by the Senate and House of Representatives... That the United States hereby disclaims any disposition or intention to exercise sovereignty, jurisdiction, or control over said Island except for the pacification thereof, and asserts its determination, when that is accomplished, to leave the government and control of the Island to its people." --- DOCUMENT 3 Platt Amendment, 1901, Statutes at Large of the United States — public domain: "The government of Cuba consents that the United States may exercise the right to intervene for the preservation of Cuban independence, the maintenance of a government adequate for protecting life, property, and individual liberty, and for discharging the obligations with respect to Cuba imposed by the Treaty of Paris on the United States... Cuba will sell or lease to the United States lands necessary for coaling or naval stations at certain specified points to be agreed upon with the President of the United States."